The Curse and the Promise

Genesis 3:14–24 · Romans 5:12–21

The big idea: God judged the serpent, the woman, and the man, but in the middle of the curse he promised a Rescuer: the woman's offspring would crush the serpent's head. Adam's sin brought death to all; Christ's obedience brings life to all who trust him.

Before you meet: Read

Genesis 3:14–24 | Romans 5:12–21

Open (5 minutes)

When have you had to live with the consequences of someone else's choice? How did it feel?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

God said to the serpent about the woman's offspring, "He shall bruise your _____, and you shall bruise his _____." *(Genesis 3:15)*

"And the LORD God made for Adam and for his wife garments of _____ and clothed them." *(Genesis 3:21)*

"For as by the one man's disobedience the many were made sinners, so by the one man's _____ the many will be made righteous." *(Romans 5:19)*

Discuss

1. Adam blamed Eve and God. Eve blamed the serpent. Where do you see the blame chain in our world, and in your own life? *Genesis 3:12–13*

2. God spoke the promise of a Rescuer in the middle of the judgment, before he said a word to Adam and Eve about pain and thorns and dust. Why does that matter? *Genesis 3:14–15*

3. Adam acted for all of us, and Christ acts for all who trust him. Why is the idea of a representative both the bad news and the good news? *Romans 5:18–19*

Memory verse

"I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and her offspring; he shall bruise your head, and you shall bruise his heel."

Genesis 3:15

Pray

Thank God that he promised a Rescuer on the darkest day, and that Jesus, the Offspring, was bruised for you and clothes you in his righteousness.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 8

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Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Genesis 3:14–24 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the three fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Genesis 4 and 5).

Main points to land

1. Genesis 3:15 is the first gospel. In the middle of the judgment, God promised a child of the woman who would be wounded and would crush the serpent's head.
2. God covered their shame with garments of skins. Something died so that sinners could be clothed, the first thread of the Lamb (Genesis 3:21).
3. Adam represented us in the covenant of works, and we fell with him: we share his guilt and his corrupted nature. Christ, the Second Adam, represents all who trust him, and his obedience makes them righteous (Romans 5:12, 18–19).

Core doctrine to teach

Original Sin CORE DOCTRINE 4 OF 26

When Adam, the head of the human race, disobeyed God, all humanity fell with him. Since then every person is born guilty and with a heart bent away from God. Sin is more than bad choices. It is a condition we cannot cure ourselves.

Genesis 3; Psalm 51:5; Romans 5:12, 18–19; Ephesians 2:1–3

Answer key (Observe)

1. head; heel
2. skins
3. obedience

Questions people will ask

Is it fair that Adam's sin counts against me?

Adam had every advantage: an upright nature, a perfect world, one clear command. None of us would have done better. And each of us has added our own sins to his (Romans 3:23). Most of all, the same principle that ruined us in Adam saves us in Christ. If one man could not act for many, one Man could not save many.

Closing prayer

Father, we confess that we have sewn our own fig leaves and pointed our fingers like Adam and Eve. Thank you that you came looking for us, that you promised a Rescuer in the darkest hour, and that you sent your Son, the Second Adam, to be bruised for us and to crush the serpent's head. Clothe us in his righteousness, and draw each one here out of hiding. Amen.